

Tiptop Virtual Academy Rulebook

The Institutional Laws of the Academy

Version: 2.0 Foundation Draft

Preamble

The Rulebook establishes the immutable laws that govern the operation of Tiptop Virtual Academy.

Unlike procedures, workflows, or policies, these laws define conditions that are always true within the Academy.

Policies may evolve.

Processes may improve.

Technology may change.

These laws remain constant unless the Academy intentionally redefines its institutional model.

Every workflow, software system, AI capability, report, and operational decision shall comply with these laws.

Section I — Laws of Identity

Law 1.1

Every person within the Academy shall possess one unique institutional identity.

Law 1.2

A digital account represents a person.

It is never the person.

Law 1.3

No person may possess multiple institutional identities for the same role without explicit institutional approval.

Law 1.4

Every identity has one authoritative owner.

Section II — Laws of Students

Law 2.1

A Student must originate from a valid admission process unless explicitly exempted by institutional policy.

Law 2.2

A Student cannot exist without at least one active or historical Enrollment.

Law 2.3

A Student may have multiple Parents or Guardians.

Law 2.4

A Parent or Guardian may support multiple Students.

Law 2.5

Every Student belongs to one academic journey at any point in time, even if enrolled in multiple learning experiences.

Law 2.6

Student academic history is permanent and auditable.

Section III — Laws of Learning

Law 3.1

Every Lesson belongs to exactly one Subject.

Law 3.2

Every Subject belongs to at least one Programme.

Law 3.3

Every Lesson shall define an intended learning outcome.

Law 3.4

Learning activities exist to support Lessons.

They shall not exist independently.

Law 3.5

Assignments are evidence of learning.

They are not learning itself.

Law 3.6

Assessment exists to improve learning before it measures performance.

Section IV — Laws of Teaching

Law 4.1

Every Lesson shall have an accountable Teacher.

Law 4.2

Only appropriately authorized educators may assess learner performance.

Law 4.3

Professional judgment remains the responsibility of educators.

Technology may assist.

Technology may never replace accountability.

Law 4.4

Teaching quality is continuously evaluated.

Not periodically assumed.

Section V — Laws of Academic Records

Law 5.1

Every Grade originates from an Assessment.

Law 5.2

Grades may be corrected.

Corrections shall always be traceable.

Law 5.3

Academic records shall never be altered without preserving institutional history.

Law 5.4

Every academic decision must be supported by evidence.

Section VI — Laws of Finance

Law 6.1

Every financial transaction must have an accountable owner.

Law 6.2

Every Payment must relate to a legitimate financial obligation or approved adjustment.

Law 6.3

No financial record shall be permanently deleted.

Law 6.4

Financial history is immutable.

Adjustments are recorded as new transactions rather than by erasing previous ones.

Section VII — Laws of Information

Law 7.1

Every institutional record has one authoritative source.

Law 7.2

Information may be shared.

Ownership may not.

Law 7.3

Every significant institutional action shall produce an auditable record.

Law 7.4

Institutional information shall be protected according to its sensitivity.

Law 7.5

Data quality is a shared institutional responsibility.

Section VIII — Laws of Technology

Law 8.1

Technology exists to support institutional operations.

Institutional operations shall never be redesigned merely to satisfy technology.

Law 8.2

Every digital capability must support an identifiable institutional objective.

Law 8.3

Automation shall eliminate unnecessary work, not necessary human judgment.

Law 8.4

Artificial Intelligence provides recommendations.

Institutional accountability remains human.

Law 8.5

Technology platforms are replaceable.

Institutional knowledge is not.

Section IX — Laws of Governance

Law 9.1

Every institutional decision has an accountable owner.

Law 9.2

Authority may be delegated.

Accountability remains with the designated owner.

Law 9.3

Institutional policies shall align with the Constitution.

Law 9.4

Operational procedures shall align with institutional policies.

Law 9.5

Software implementations shall align with operational procedures.

This establishes the hierarchy:

Constitution

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Policies

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Operational Procedures

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Technology

Technology never sits above governance.

Section X — Laws of Quality

Law 10.1

Every institutional process is subject to continuous improvement.

Law 10.2

Quality is measured using evidence rather than assumption.

Law 10.3

Errors are opportunities for learning.

Repeated errors require systemic improvement.

Law 10.4

Institutional excellence is a continuous pursuit rather than a fixed destination.

Section XI — Laws of Relationships

Law 11.1

Every relationship within the Academy shall have a clearly defined purpose.

Law 11.2

No institutional entity may exist without belonging to an identified domain.

Law 11.3

No domain shall own another domain's information.

Domains collaborate through defined interfaces and shared understanding.

Law 11.4

Every entity shall possess a defined lifecycle.

Law 11.5

Every lifecycle transition shall be triggered by an identifiable event.

Section XII — The Foundational Laws

The Academy recognizes the following as its highest operational truths:

- Reality precedes technology.
 - Purpose precedes process.
 - Process precedes software.
 - Information has one source of truth.
 - Ownership is singular.
 - Accountability is explicit.
 - Technology serves people.
 - Artificial Intelligence augments human capability.
 - Learning is the Academy's highest purpose.
 - Every institutional decision shall ultimately improve the learner's experience.
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Closing Declaration

These Institutional Laws define the operational physics of Tiptop Virtual Academy.

They establish the boundaries within which innovation, leadership, education, technology, and continuous improvement may flourish.

They are intended to endure across changing curricula, evolving technologies, organizational growth, and future generations of learners, ensuring that the Academy remains coherent, trustworthy, and faithful to its mission.